

BRIAN SHIMKUS

FORWARD-DEPLOYED / APPLIED AI ENGINEER

CUSTOMER SYSTEMS / INTEGRATIONS / REGULATED WORKFLOWS

Chicago, IL | brian@brianshimkus.com | brianshimkus.com | linkedin.com/in/brianshimkus1 | github.com/brianshimkus

Forward-deployed and applied AI engineer with 12 years delivering customer-facing software, including regulated financial-services workflows. Led broker and trader onboarding modernization at Marex, integrated DocuSign, ran stakeholder discovery and demonstrations, and managed a five-person team. Now builds Salesforce, RAG, and API systems with OAuth 2.0/JWT, source grounding, human review, and reliability design spanning idempotent writes, webhook handling, retries, and reconciliation.

SKILLS

CORE EXPERTISE

APPLIED AI	OpenAI API, LLMs, RAG, LangChain, Pinecone/vector databases, Structured Outputs, evaluations, guardrails, Python, FastAPI
INTEGRATIONS	Salesforce API, DocuSign API, REST, JSON, OAuth 2.0/JWT, webhooks, SQL, MySQL, AWS
ENGINEERING	TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Git, Jest, Playwright, Vercel
CUSTOMER DELIVERY	Discovery, problem decomposition, workflow mapping, demos, proof of concept/value (POC/POV), stakeholder alignment, technical handoff

WHERE I'VE DELIVERED

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Applied AI & Integration Engineer

Dec 2025 - Present

Insolla / Consulting and portfolio practice

- Build customer-facing AI and integration systems across CRM intelligence, identity governance, and document operations, connecting live third-party platforms through REST APIs, webhooks, and automation tooling.
- Reduced a client's social-media workflow from 8 hours/week to 10 minutes through an automated content pipeline scoped and delivered directly with the owner.
- Translate discovery into solution walkthroughs, security briefs, proof-of-value plans, and documented technical handoff, keeping customer decisions, data risks, and implementation tradeoffs explicit.
- Design Salesforce integrations with scoped access, OAuth 2.0 JWT authentication, source grounding, human review, and documented data handling.

Lead Front-End Developer

Aug 2025 - Dec 2025

TerraFort / Freelance

- Led design and development of a web and mobile platform at an early-stage startup, executing product initiatives from concept through delivery.
- Owned vendor technical evaluations and scoped third-party and AI integrations while coordinating across UX, product, and backend teams.

Senior Front-End Developer

Jul 2024 - Jun 2025

OCC / Contract

- Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility, aligning goals, demonstrating progress, and resolving open questions across workstreams.
- Delivered React and TypeScript solutions from Figma through test, QA, and production; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock development from backend dependencies.

Lead Front-End Developer

Oct 2020 - Jan 2024

Marex

- Led the program that digitized broker and trader onboarding at a global financial-services firm, replacing a compliance-heavy paper workflow with an end-to-end digital process.
- Won adoption from trading and operations teams by partnering with compliance and operations stakeholders to scope each rollout.
- Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across products.
- Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions; designed and ran the team's internship program.

SELECTED WORK

FEATURED FORWARD-DEPLOYED SYSTEMS

Casefile - Investigation Copilot

IN PROGRESS

Designing an investigation copilot for a fictional insurance Special Investigations Unit that will ingest five disagreeing claims sources, resolve claimant, vehicle, vendor, and policy entities, flag conflicts and anomalies, and answer investigator questions with cited evidence.

Evaluation plan: Entity-resolution precision, recall, and false-merge rate; retrieval recall, citation correctness, and unsupported-answer rate; zero duplicate records or tasks across forced write re-runs.

Safety and status: Evidence assembly and human escalation only - never fraud labeling, coverage denial, or adverse action. Phase 0 discovery is underway; planned scope spans multi-source ingestion, deterministic scoring, RAG/tool orchestration, live APIs, cloud deployment, and security testing.

Salesforce Intelligence

LIVE DEMO

Retrieval-augmented assistant that answers natural-language questions across Salesforce Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities. Synchronizes records into Pinecone and returns responses linked to source CRM rows. Built with Python, LangChain, and OpenAI.

Demonstrated outcome: Converts a multi-record CRM lookup into one sourced response in seconds.

Controls: OAuth 2.0 JWT, scoped fields, server-side credentials, source citations, and explicit unsupported-answer handling.

[Case study](#) | [Live demo](#) | [Source code](#)

FOUNDATION

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Developer / Walker & Dunlop (Contract) - Built Vue.js and Storybook components connected to APIs.	Mar 2020 - Oct 2020
Senior Front-End Developer / ICF - Led the front-end lifecycle and standardized web accessibility across projects.	Jan 2019 - Mar 2020
Front-End Developer / TransUnion - Built a Contentful-based CMS for marketing owners and deployed to AWS.	Jan 2018 - Jan 2019
UX Architect and Front-End Developer / R1 RCM - Identified product gaps with directors and prototyped solutions in AngularJS.	Apr 2016 - Jan 2018
Front-End Developer / TimeZoneOne (Contract) - Built WordPress themes for Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.	Aug 2015 - Apr 2016
Junior Front-End Developer / Kohactive - Built Rails/SASS sites and led client meetings with Aon, Manchester United, and The Vitality Group.	Aug 2013 - Aug 2015

EDUCATION

FORMAL TRAINING

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design / Art Institute of Chicago - 3.9 GPA, Dean's List	2013
Instructional Design and Technology / Western Illinois University	2008 - 2010